

Breathe in, breathe out

Breathing in and out brings oxygen into the lungs and removes the harmful waste gas, carbon dioxide. The process involves the diaphragm and the intercostal muscles, which are found between the ribs.

Intercostal muscles
pull the ribs
upward and
outward

Lungs expand as
the chest gets bigger

Diaphragm contracts,
flattens, and pushes
downward

Air in...

The diaphragm and intercostal muscles contract (tighten) to increase the size of the space inside the chest. As this happens, the lungs expand and fresh air enters from outside.

